

Your website should cost \$12 a year.

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shortforge.dev/websites

I'm a software engineer in Chicago. For seven years I've built systems for global banks, and I'm currently a contract developer at PepsiCo. On the side I build websites for small businesses: fast, simple, and yours outright. No monthly platform bill, and **about \$12 a year** to keep online.

WHAT EVERY SITE COMES WITH

Works on a phone

Most of your customers will find you on a phone. The site is built for that first, not shrunk down to fit.

Hours, location, map

The three things people actually came looking for, above the fold, on every device.

Your photos, done right

Resized and compressed so a gallery of twenty pictures does not take thirty seconds to load.

Loads fast

Hand-written code, no page builder underneath. Pages open in about a second, even on a weak connection.

A contact form that works

Messages land in your inbox. No plugin to maintain, nothing to log into.

Findable on Google

Real page titles, descriptions, and structured data so search engines can read what you sell and when you are open.

HOW IT WORKS

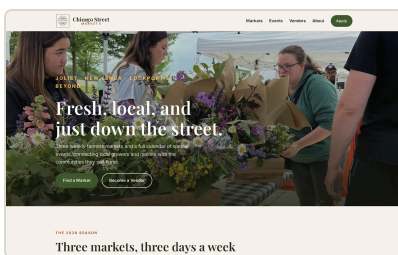
We talk for twenty minutes. Usually a phone call. What you sell, who buys it, what you want the site to do. I tell you which package fits and what it costs. No charge, no pitch deck.

You send me your stuff. Logo, photos, hours, addresses, social links. One form, one time. If you do not have good photos I will tell you honestly.

I build it and you look at it. You get a private link before anything is public. You tell me what to change. That is what the rounds of changes are for.

It goes live in your name. The domain and the hosting get set up in accounts that belong to you, with your email and your credit card. I walk you through it and then hand over the keys.

RECENT WORK



chicagostreetmarkets.com:

three weekly farmers markets in Joliet, New Lenox and Lockport. Nine pages, a full event calendar, vendor applications and a mailing list. Moved off a one-page Squarespace site; now runs for about \$12 a year, entirely in the owner's own accounts.

You own all of it: the domain, the hosting account, the code. Registered in your name, handed over at launch.

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WHAT IT COSTS

One Page

\$1,200

Everything on a single page. Ready in 2 weeks.

Storefront

\$2,800

A real site with room to grow. Ready in 4-5 weeks.

Custom Build

from \$5,000

Selling online, or moving off something else. Timeline set with the scope.

Vendor rate, 15% off, for anyone selling at Chicago Street Markets. Half up front, half at launch.

AFTER IT'S LIVE

Care plan · first year included

\$45/mo

Season change

\$250

On your own

\$0

Anything else is \$110/hr. Nothing renews on its own.

ADD-ONS

Extra page

\$250

Move off Squarespace / Wix / Etsy, with redirects

\$400

Email list setup + first newsletter template

\$300

Online ordering (Square or Shopify) added

\$450

Flyer / poster set, three web-ready sizes

\$150

AI phone agent: setup and first month

\$1,200

WORTH KNOWING UP FRONT

Photos and copy are due within two weeks of starting. If a project goes quiet for a month it gets paused, and restarting is \$250. It is the one thing that decides whether a site takes three weeks or three months.

If a website builder is genuinely the better fit for you, I will say so on the first call.